PHASE 03 / ENVIRONMENT AND CONFIGURATION

Environment and configuration

A repeatable development setup makes local work and handoff predictable.

Activities

Use Python 3.11 or newer and create a project-local virtual environment before installing requirements.

Install the pinned-range dependencies from `requirements.txt`; select `.venv` as the VS Code interpreter.

Copy `.env.example` to `.env`, set a private `SECRET_KEY`, and optionally provide `GEMINI_API_KEY` and `GEMINI_MODEL`.

Keep `.env`, SQLite files, and virtual-environment contents out of version control.

Create the SQLite database and tables during application startup; keep the database path configurable.

Phase outputs

Acceptance checks

The app starts without Gemini credentials and serves the local fallback.

Secrets are read server-side and are absent from browser assets.

A fresh checkout can create its database without manual schema steps.